Combination of foods improves the quality of nutrients. Cereals lack certain essential amino acids and these are present in dhals. On the other hand dhals lack some other essential amino acids that are present in cereals. The quality of proteins becomes as good as that of milk. The combination of a variety of foods ensures better availability of nutrients.

Combination helps to

i) Eat a diet that has good quality nutrients.
ii) Use cheaper and easily available foods that enhance the nutrient content of food considerably.
iii) Provide balanced diet to the family.

ii) Fermentation

Fermentation is a process in which some micro-organisms are added to the food. They change nutrients already present in the foods into simpler and better forms and also make other new nutrients.

Fermentation makes the dough rise and become almost double in quantity. During fermentation the microorganisms use up some of the nutrients present in the dough and change them into other better quality nutrients. They also make some new nutrients.

Curd, bread, dhokla and idli are all examples of fermented foods.

Advantages of fermentation

a) Fermentation improves the digestibility of foods. The microorganisms which cause fermentation break the proteins and carbohydrates into smaller parts, which are easier to digest.
b) During fermentation of cereals and foods like peas, beans etc. the minerals, calcium, phosphorus, and iron are changed into better quality ones. These are then easily absorbed by the body.
c) Fermented foods become spongy and soft and are liked by children and adults.

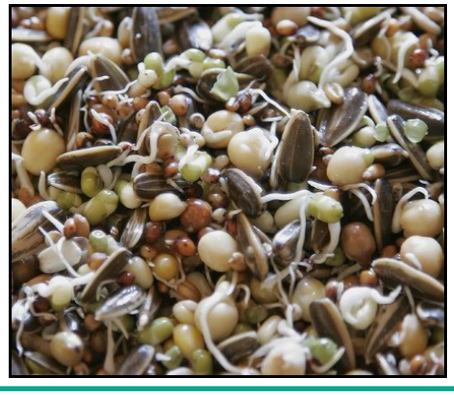
iii) Germination

Germination is a process in which small shoots come out of the dhal or cereal when these are kept with small amount of water. The grains and pulses to be sprouted need to be soaked in just enough water so that all of it is absorbed. If the extra water in which they are soaked is thrown away, a lot of nutrients are lost.

Grains like wheat, bajra, jowar, etc. can also be sprouted. These grains



Curd



Germination

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